

FOR ZACQUES · FROM MATTHEW · 7 SEPTEMBER 2026

The website plan, in plain terms

What we are building, what it costs, and the steps in order. Nothing here needs you to be technical. The two things I need from you are marked.

What we are building

One website that does four jobs and grows with us without being rebuilt:

- **Public site** at powerbyae.co.za. Services, pages the admin person can build herself, and a quote request form.
- **Customer portal.** Customers see their quotes, accept them online, see their documents and their solar system's performance.
- **Our office.** Quoting, jobs, invoicing, staff hours, monitoring and finance. You and I both log in here, each with our own login.
- **Online store,** later. Retail first, wholesale accounts when we open them.

The decisions we have made

QUESTION	ANSWER
Rebuild on something new?	No. Same system the Haberl platform runs on. It already works and any future IT person can be hired for it.
Where does it run?	The site in Europe next to the database, because no database provider has servers in South Africa. South African visitors are served from a cache in Cape Town.
Who owns it?	The company. All accounts in the company's name with both of us able to recover them.
The company	Amperage Electrical Solutions (Pty) Ltd, 2024/469778/07, already registered with a tax number. "Power by AE" is the brand on top of it; the registered name and number go on every quote and invoice.
Domain	powerbyae.co.za. Checked and free on 7 September. Buy this week, registered to the company.
Payments	PayFast. The name customers trust at checkout.
Who edits pages?	The admin person, through a page builder inside the site. Not you, not me.
Your login	You quote and do admin in the office portal from day one. You never need a developer account.

What it costs

Everything is pay-as-you-use. Nothing is paid up front and nothing is locked in.

STAGE	PER MONTH	NOTES
While building	R0	Free tiers until we have real customers in it. Domains about R400 a year.
Go-live	≈ R800 – R1 800	Hosting R360, database R450, the rest is usage. PayFast takes a percentage per sale only.
Busy, with the store	≈ R1 500 – R3 000	Grows only with traffic and sales.
Ten times our size	≈ R8 000 – R18 000	Multiple branches, wholesale accounts, thousands of monitored sites.

For comparison, a Shopify store alone would be about R6 500 a month plus a cut of every sale.

Steps, in order

- 01 Buy the domain.** powerbyae.co.za and poweredbyae.co.za, plus powerbyae.com. Registered to the company, both of us as contacts. MATTHEW
- 02 Bring Amperage Electrical Solutions (Pty) Ltd up to date.** The company already exists (registered 31 July 2024, you as sole director). Three things: file the outstanding annual returns with beneficial ownership at CIPC, appoint Matthew as a director, and decide whether "Power by AE" is a trading name on this company or a formal name change. A trademark search on "AE" is still needed before anything is printed. ZACQUES
- 03 Set up the accounts.** Hosting, database and email accounts in the company's name. Logins go into our shared password list. MATTHEW
- 04 Build the foundation and logins.** Roles and permissions first, so you can log in and test every section as it is built. MATTHEW
- 05 Public site and quote request.** The designer gives us a set of page sections; the admin person builds pages from them. MATTHEW
- 06 Quoting.** Customers, sites, leads and both quote types. You test it on real quotes. MATTHEW ZACQUES TESTS
- 07 Go live.** Backups switched on, domain and email pointed at the new site, Haberl customers moved across. MATTHEW
- 08 After launch.** Jobs, invoicing, finance, staff hours, calendar, monitoring. In that order, by what brings money in soonest.
- 09 Store.** Retail checkout with PayFast first. The wholesale system is added the day we open our first trade account.

WHAT I NEED FROM YOU

- CIPC annual returns filed, Matthew appointed as director, and the trading-name decision (step 2).
- A check with SARS that the company's income tax returns are up to date. Financial year end is February, so the first return was due by February 2026.
- Your email address for your portal login, and a second phone number for account recovery.
- Half an hour to test the quoting screens once they are up (step 6).

Full technical report with sources is with Matthew.